experience cannot be grasped by science seemed to him a matter of painful but inevitable resignation.”

This resignation leaves open a pivotal question: Is science unable to grasp a fundamental quality of time that the human mind embraces as readily as the lungs take in air, or does the human mind impose on time a quality of its own making, one that is artificial and that hence does not show up in the laws of physics? If you were to ask me this question during the working day, I’d side with the latter perspective, but by nightfall, when critical thought eases into the ordinary routines of life, it’s hard to maintain full resistance to the former viewpoint. Time is a subtle subject and we are far from understanding it fully. It is possible that some insightful person will one day devise a new way of looking at time and reveal a bona fide physical foundation for a time that flows. Then again, the discussion above, based on logic and relativity, may turn out to be the full story. Certainly, though, the feeling that time flows is deeply ingrained in our experience and thoroughly pervades our thinking and language. So much so, that we have lapsed, and will continue to lapse, into habitual, colloquial descriptions that refer to a flowing time. But don’t confuse language with reality. Human language is far better at capturing human experience than at expressing deep physical laws.